Environment variables: what to add, and where

All of these go in **Vercel → the avvvs project → Settings → Environment Variables**. Tick **Production** (and **Preview** too, unless a row says otherwise), then **redeploy** (Deployments → latest → ⋯ → Redeploy). Changes don't apply until the next deploy, and every `NEXT_PUBLIC_…` value is baked in at build time.

For local development, put the same names in `web/.env.local` (copy `web/.env.example`). Never commit `.env.local`: the repo is public.

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1. Needed for the site to work fully

Enquiry form (the "Work With Us" / "Discuss manufacturing" form)

Without these, the form shows an error in production and **no enquiry reaches you**.

Name	Example	Where to get it
`SMTP_HOST`	`smtp.gmail.com` / `smtp.zoho.in` / `smtp.office365.com`	Your email provider's SMTP settings
`SMTP_PORT`	`587`	Usually 587. Use 465 if the provider says "SSL"
`SMTP_SECURE`	*(leave empty)*	`true` only when the port is 465
`SMTP_USER`	`website@avvvs.com`	The mailbox that sends the mail
`SMTP_PASS`	*(secret)*	That mailbox's **app password** (Google/Microsoft: create one under the account's security settings; your normal password won't work with 2-step sign-in on)
`MAIL_FROM`	`website@avvvs.com`	The "From" address. Must be the SMTP user or an alias it is allowed to send as
`MAIL_TO`	`mail@avvvs.com`	Where enquiries arrive. If empty, it uses the contact email on the site
`SEND_ACK`	`false`	`true` also sends the enquirer a short "we have your enquiry" email

Journal admin (`/admin`)

Name	Where to get it
`DATABASE_URL`	**Set automatically.** Vercel → project → **Storage** → **Create** → **Neon (Postgres)** → connect it to this project. Tables create themselves on first use
`BLOB_READ_WRITE_TOKEN`	**Set automatically.** Vercel → project → **Storage** → **Create** → **Blob** → connect it to this project. Holds images uploaded in the editor

Name	Where to get it
`ADMIN_SETUP_KEY`	**You make it up.** Any long random phrase, 16+ characters. Used once at `/admin/setup` to create the first admin account. Keep it private

After the redeploy: open `/admin/setup`, enter the setup key, create your account, and add the other writers from **Users** inside the admin.

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2. When the real domain goes live

Name	Value	Notes
`NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL`	`https://avvvs.com`	Set it only once avvvs.com points to this Vercel site. Until then leave it **unset**: the site uses the Vercel production domain by itself. Production only, not Preview. Drives canonical links, hreflang, sitemap, robots, share cards and structured data

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3. Optional: analytics and verification

Each one only switches on when it has a value, and the trackers load only after a visitor accepts cookies. Production only is fine.

Name	Example	Where to get it
`NEXT_PUBLIC_GA_ID`	`G-XXXXXXXXXX`	Google Analytics → Admin → Data streams → your web stream → Measurement ID
`NEXT_PUBLIC_META_PIXEL_ID`	`1234567890`	Meta Events Manager → Data sources → your pixel's ID
`NEXT_PUBLIC_GSC_VERIFICATION`	`abc123…`	Google Search Console → Add property → **HTML tag** method → copy only the `content="…"` value
`NEXT_PUBLIC_META_DOMAIN_VERIFICATION`	`xyz789…`	Meta Business Settings → Brand safety → Domains → **Meta-tag** method → the `content` value

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Do not add these

Vercel sets them itself, and the site reads them automatically: `VERCEL_ENV`, `VERCEL_PROJECT_PRODUCTION_URL`, `NODE_ENV`, `NEXT_PUBLIC_DEPLOY_ENV`.

(`NEXT_PUBLIC_DEPLOY_ENV` is derived from `VERCEL_ENV` so preview links stay out of Google.)

Checklist

- [ ] SMTP: `SMTP_HOST`, `SMTP_PORT`, `SMTP_USER`, `SMTP_PASS`, `MAIL_FROM`, `MAIL_TO`
- [ ] Storage → Neon connected (`DATABASE_URL` appears)
- [ ] Storage → Blob connected (`BLOB_READ_WRITE_TOKEN` appears)
- [ ] `ADMIN_SETUP_KEY` added
- [ ] Redeployed
- [ ] Sent a test enquiry and it arrived
- [ ] Created the first admin at `/admin/setup`
- [ ] *(later)* `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL` once the domain is moved
- [ ] *(optional)* GA, Meta Pixel, Search Console, Meta domain verification